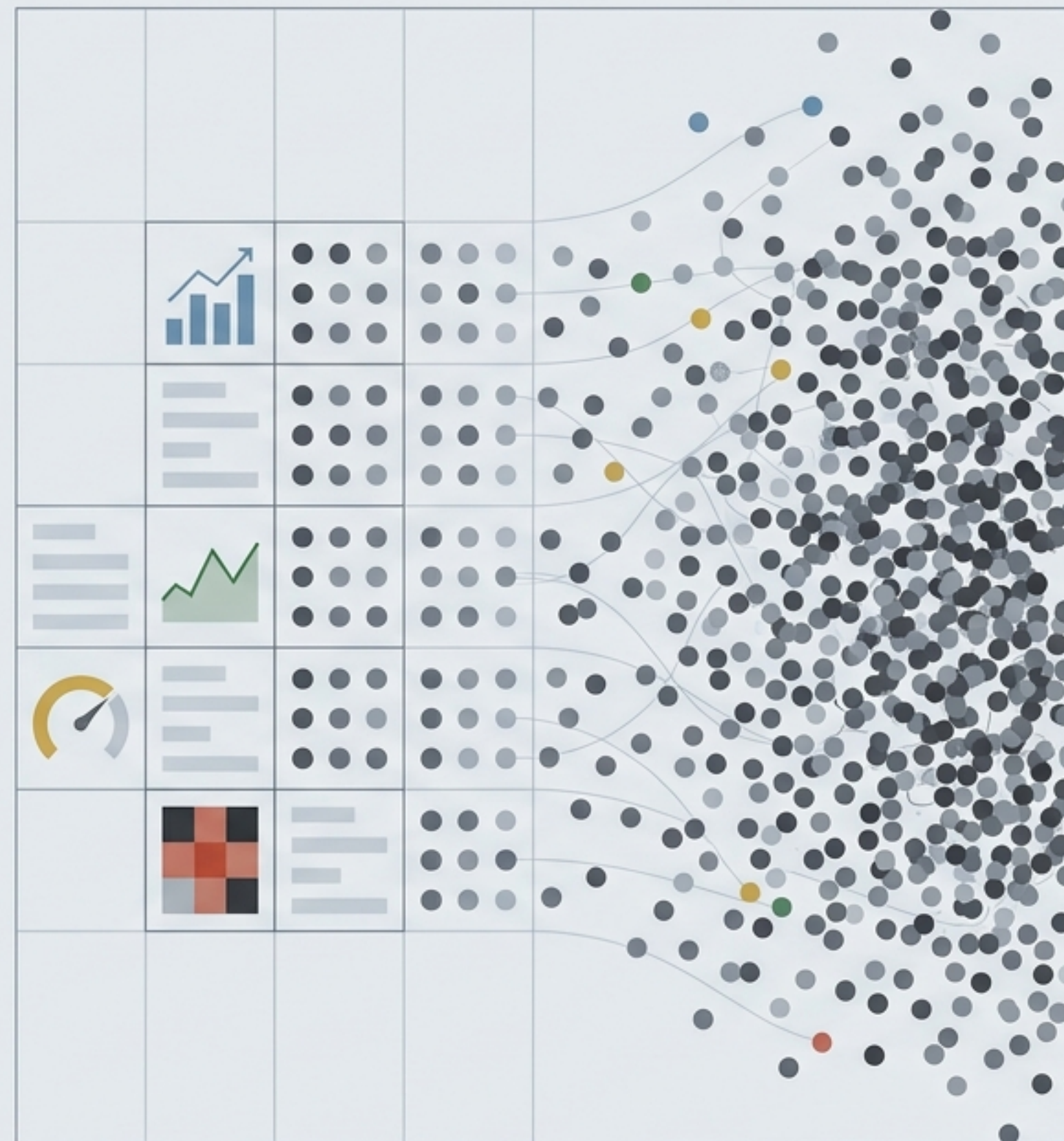


DECODING THE PLAY STORE

MARKET DYNAMICS, QUALITY
BENCHMARKS, AND
REVENUE OPPORTUNITIES



Data Foundation & Processing

01 / Ingestion

10,841
raw applications

13
diverse
attributes

App	Category	Reviews	Size	Installs	Type	Content Rating	Genre	Last Updated	Current Ver	Release Ver
Photo Editor & Collage Maker	ART_AND_DESIGN	4.1	15M	10M+	Free	Everyone	Art & Design	January 7, 2016...		
Photo Editor & Collage Maker	ART_AND_DESIGN	4.1	15M	10M+	Free	Everyone	Art & Design	January 7, 2016...		
...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...
...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...
...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...

02 / Standardization

15M → **15,000,000**

Size & Installs Transformations
Feature Engineering

03 / Refinement

Missing Ratings

Dataset Mean



NaN



4.19

Null Value Handling &
Statistical Integrity

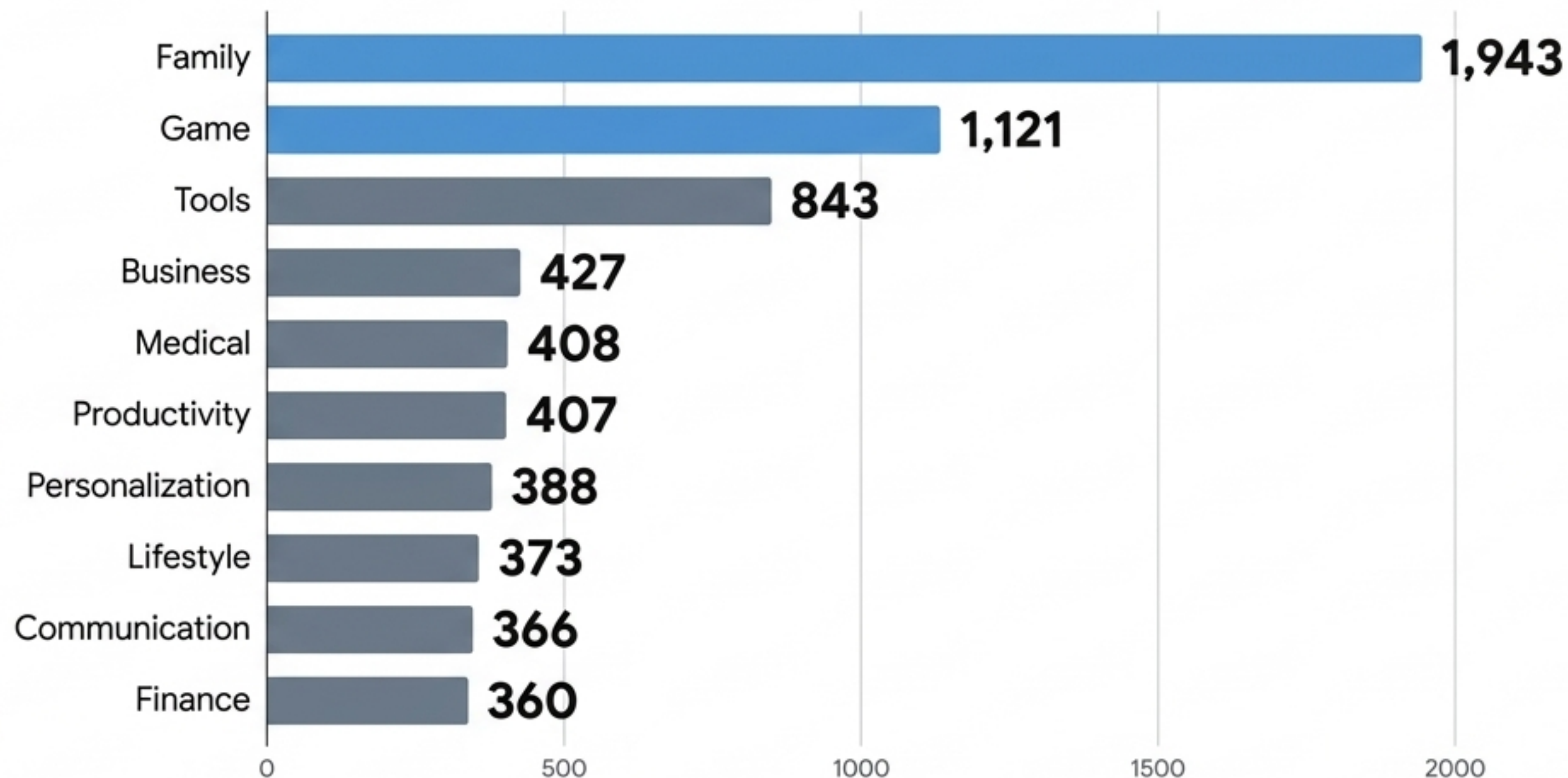
Final Dataset: A robust foundation for multivariate market analysis.

The App Landscape is Highly Concentrated

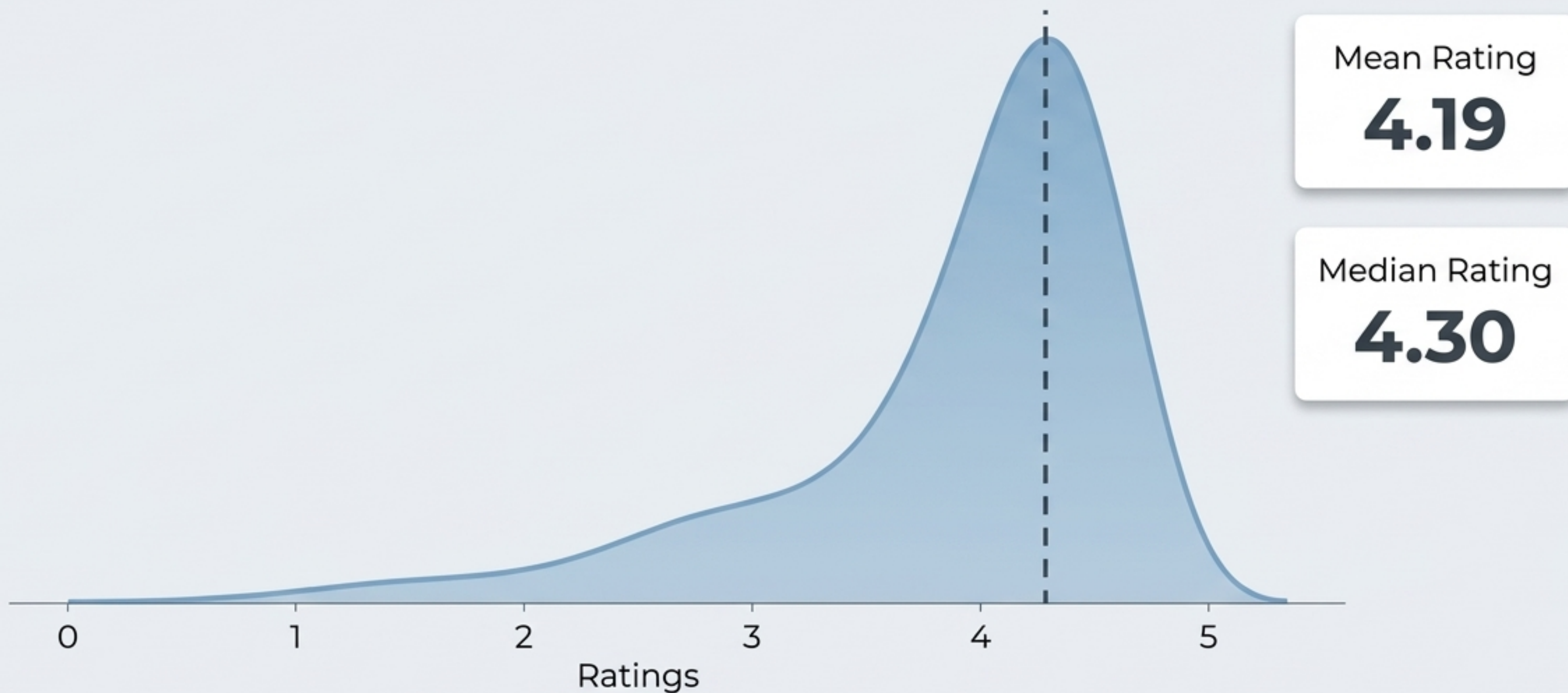
The Play Store is not a flat marketplace. Over 28% of the market is concentrated in just two major categories, indicating intense competition for attention in entertainment and household utility.



Top 10 App Categories



The Baseline for 'Good' is Higher Than Expected



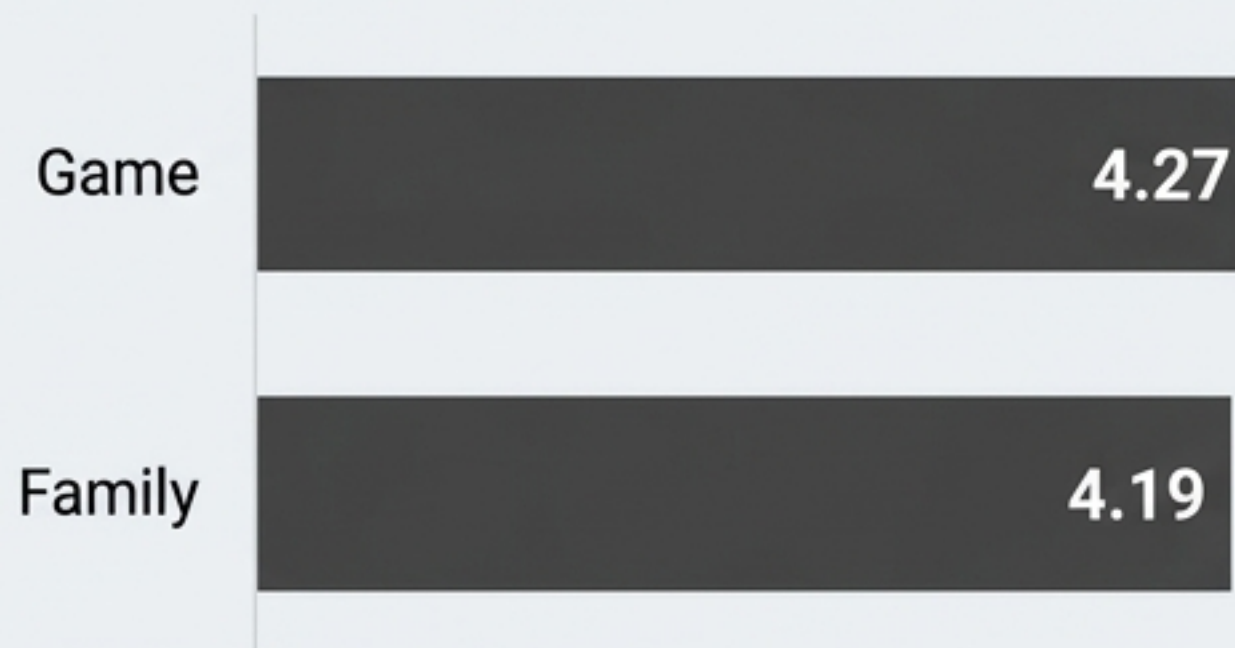
User sentiment heavily skews positive. A rating of 4.0 is not “average”—it is functionally below average. To be competitive, an app must target >4.3.

Niche Categories Outperform the Mass Market in Satisfaction

Niche Leaders (Top Sentiment)



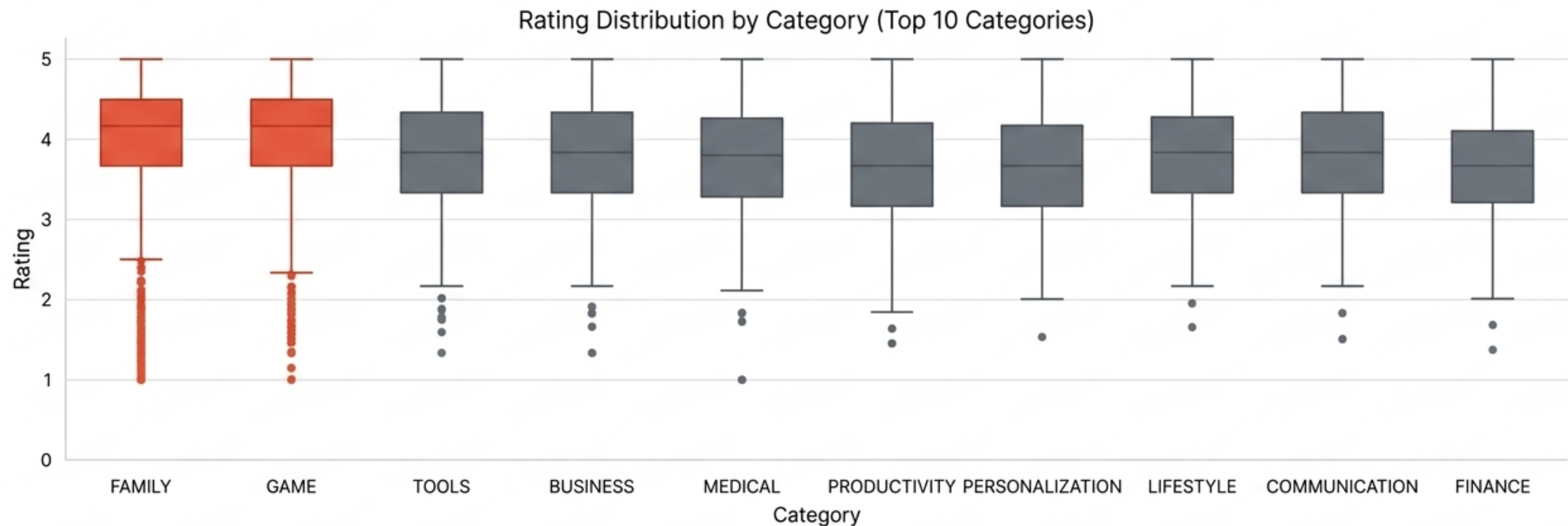
Volume Leaders (Mass Market)



Higher utility and specific intent drive higher user satisfaction than broad entertainment categories.

The Variance of Quality Within Top Categories

PREMIUM MARKET INTELLIGENCE

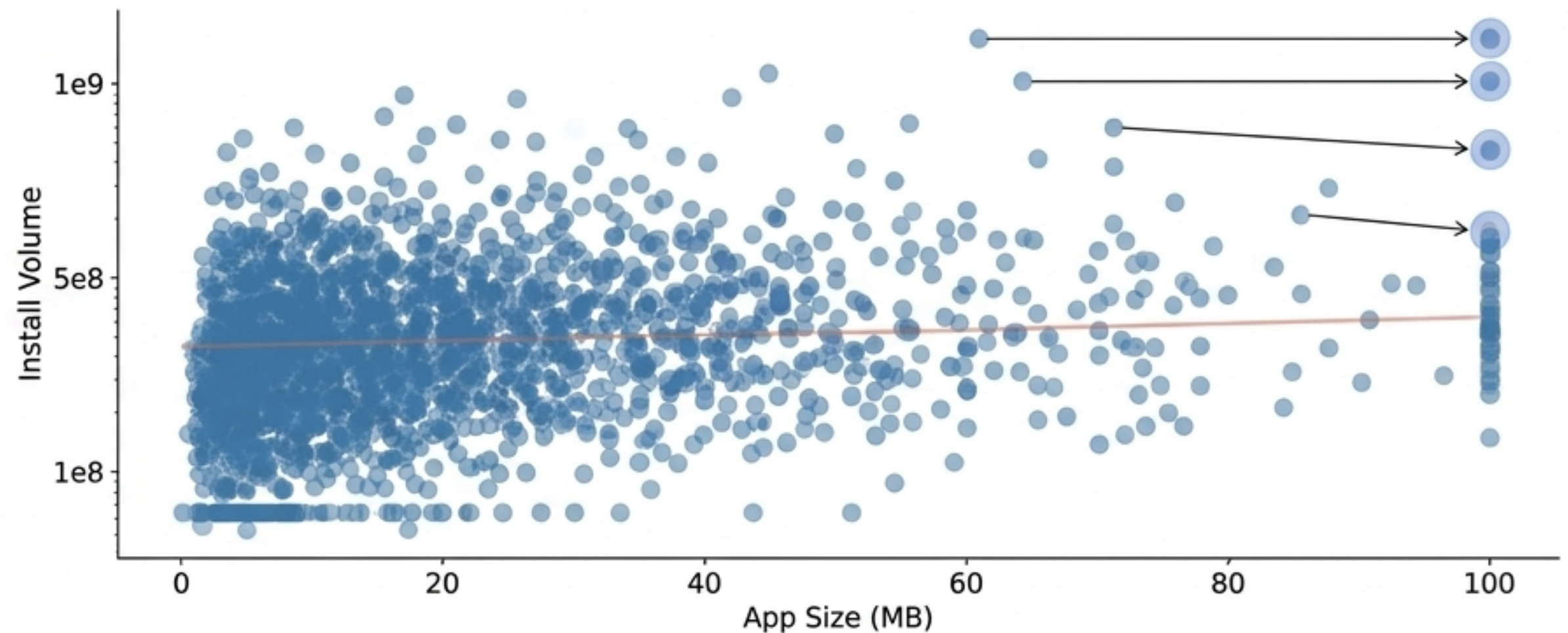


The Minefield: High-volume categories like Family and Game have high medians but massive spreads of low-rated duds.

The Opportunity: Users regularly encounter poorly built apps in these saturated spaces, creating massive openings for premium, highly polished entrants.

App Size Does Not Constrain Market Penetration

**Pearson
Correlation
(r): 0.17**

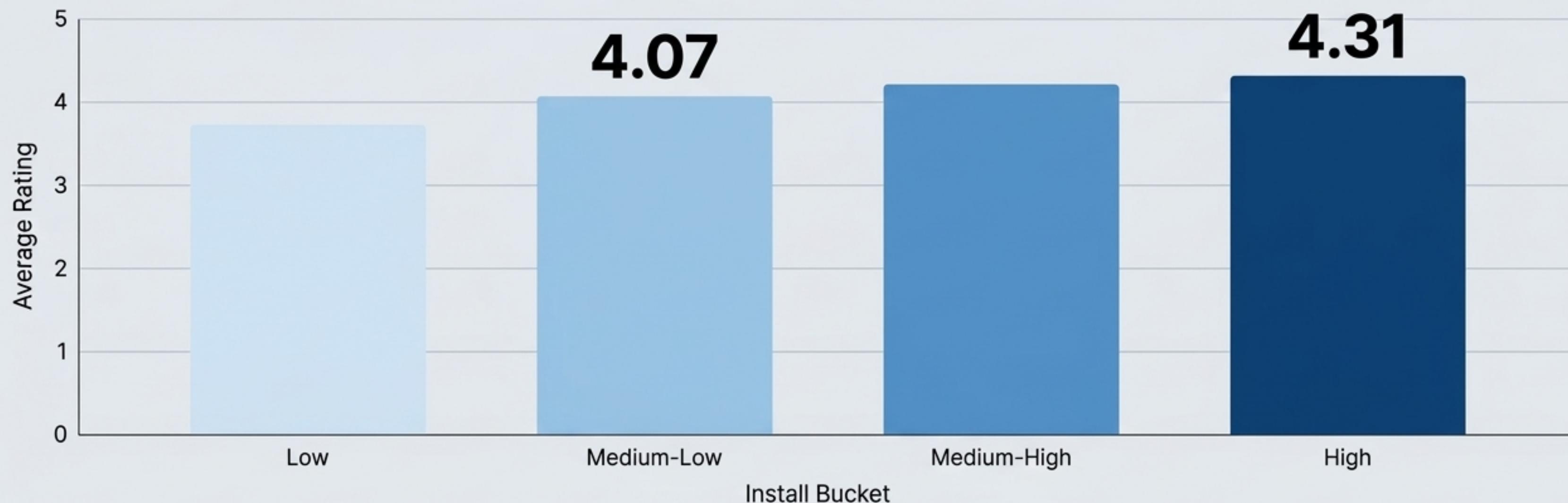


With a weak positive correlation (0.17), app size is fundamentally decoupled from install volume. Users readily download heavy apps if the perceived value is sufficient.

Popularity and Satisfaction Create a Growth Flywheel

PREMIUM MARKET INTELLIGENCE

Average App Rating by Install Bucket



There is a positive association between massive reach and user rating. Scale does not dilute quality; rather, highly optimized experiences are structurally required to reach the highest install tiers.

The Market Defaults to Free

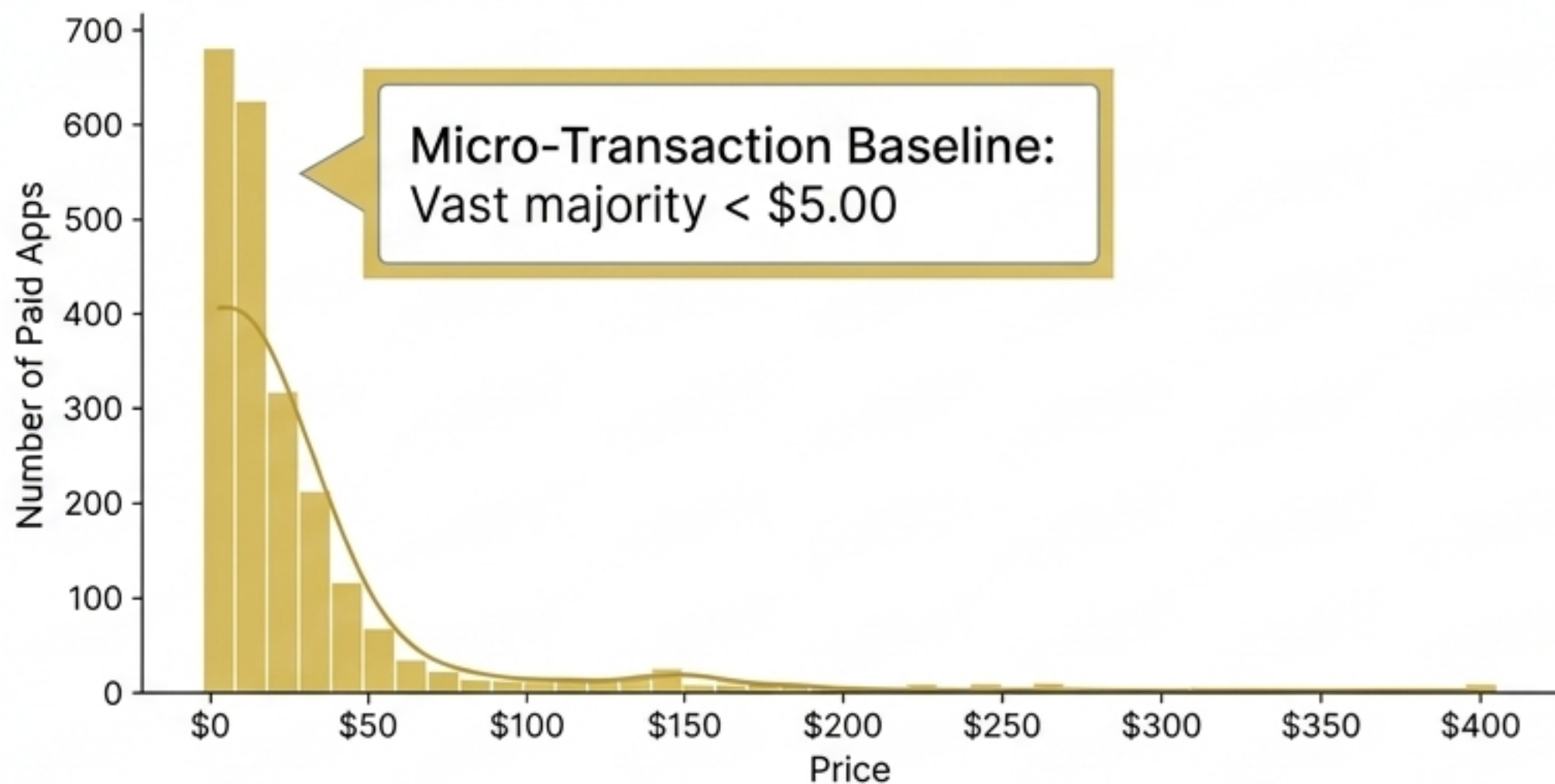
92% FREE
(9,591 apps)

8% PAID
(765 apps)

Upfront pricing is a severe exception in the Play Store. Monetization for 92% of the market relies entirely on scale (ads, in-app purchases, or freemium models).

The Micro-Transaction Baseline for Paid Apps

Price Distribution of Paid Apps



Mean Price

\$13.95

(Heavily skewed by extreme outliers)

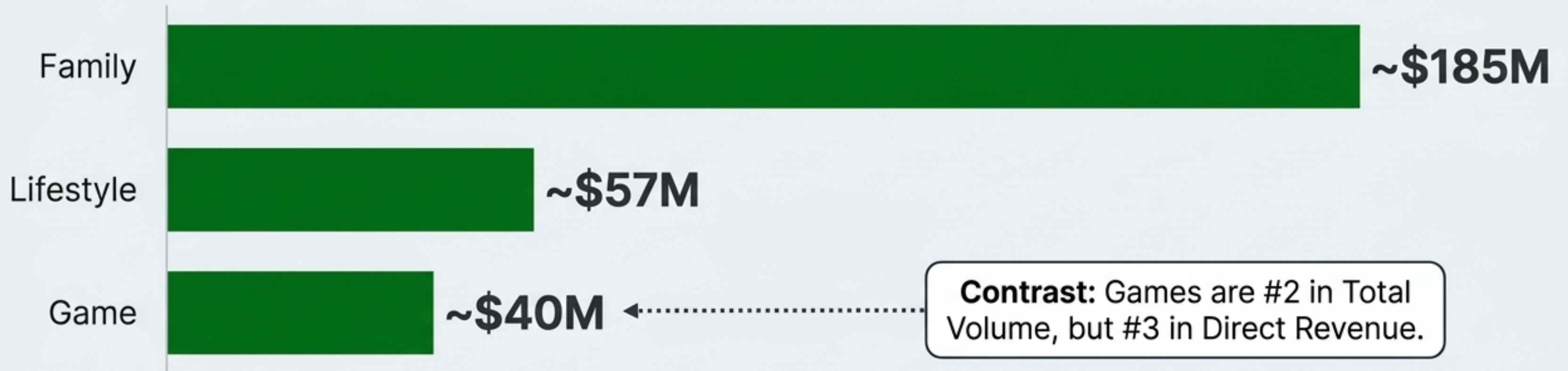
Max Price Outlier

\$400.00

**Within the paid ecosystem, consumer friction is incredibly high.
Developers must rely on micro-pricing to convert users.**

Revenue Leaders Diverge from Volume Leaders

Estimated Direct Revenue



While **Games** drive massive free install volume, the **Family** and **Lifestyle** categories generate **vastly disproportionate direct revenue**. Parents and niche-utility seekers are willing to pay upfront.

The Play Store Strategic Matrix

The Quality Imperative

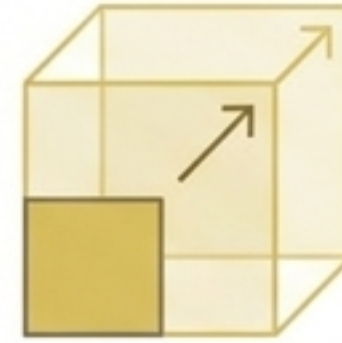
Do not launch until internal testing surpasses a 4.3 sentiment score.



A 4.0 is below average.

Technical Freedom

Do not compromise feature sets to shrink file size.



Data shows users willingly download massive files for valuable content ($r=0.17$).

Monetization Targeting

Default to 'Free + IAP' for highly competitive categories (Games).



Utilize upfront 'Paid' models for high-trust, high-intent niches (Family, Lifestyle).